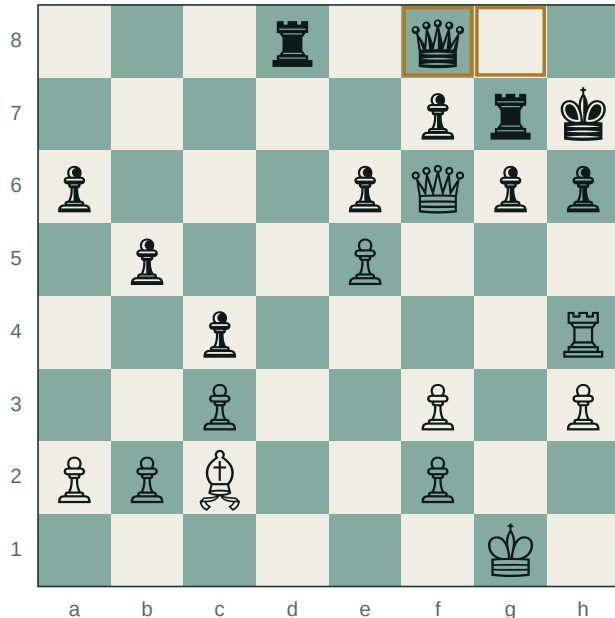


Clearance tactics: White, move 30

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 29...Qf8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30. Rxh6+ Kg8 31. Qh4

30.Rxh6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on h6. Recorded reply: **30...Kg8**.

31.Qh4 The queen moves from f6 to h4.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -2 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on h7. Absolute pin: pawn on h6 and pawn on g6.